Imperator Black — Quick Reference rules v0.4

The round

• **Initiative:** each side 2d6 + the Nerve of its Leader with the highest Nerve. Winner chooses who activates first. Reroll ties.
• **Activations:** alternate one model at a time; two actions each. When one side runs out, the other finishes.
• **End of round:** (1) Bleeding/Critical clocks; (2) Down models test 8+ to recover; (3) unhit models in cover lose 1 Suppression; (4) hazards; (5) mission effects; (6) clear Activated (Overwatch stays).

Attributes

Attr.	Used for
MOV	Inches per Move action (usually 5-7). Training, exoskeletons and heavy kit all show here.
SHT	Hit rolls, Suppressive Fire and reaction shots.
FGT	Close combat exchanges.
PHY	Throwing, forcing doors with a breaching tool, holding on in decompression, getting up when Down.
NRV	Breaking tests, Find Cover, and initiative for Leaders.
TEC	Medic actions, hacking, putting out fires and other technical work.
W	Wounded markers a model can carry; one more puts it Down.
SZ	Physical bulk: 1 small drone, 2 human, 3 large (walkers and vehicles are larger). Used by rules for hatches, cover and vehicles.

A test is 2d6 + the named attribute, −1 per Suppression, −1 if Wounded; 8+ unless stated. Rank is a label only.

Actions

Action	Effect
Move	Up to Move. Obstacle +2". Contact with an enemy starts close combat.
Shoot	Hit roll vs a visible target.
Aim	+1 to the next Shoot this activation.
Suppressive Fire	Auto only. Hit: +1 Suppression (+2 if beating 8 by 3+). No damage.
Throw	Grenade; 2d6 + Physique, 8+ to land on the point. Handy.
Overwatch	Last action. Up to two reactions before this model next activates.
Find Cover	In the open within 1" of micro-terrain: 2d6 + Nerve, 7+ Light, 10+ Heavy.
Rally	Remove 1 Suppression from self or a friend within 6" (2 with a Leader).
Medic	Treat a Down/Bleeding/Critical friend in contact.
Interact	Objective, door, console or charge within 1".

Reactions

• **Who:** a model not yet activated (it becomes Activated), or a model on Overwatch (up to two).
• **Triggers (in its line of sight):** enemy Moves (interrupt anywhere along the move); Shoots, Throws, Suppressive Fire or Interacts (after); comes into view of an Overwatch model for any reason (at once).
• **Door opens:** (1) resolve the opening; (2) cracked-in grenade lands; (3) far side reacts; (4) opening side's Overwatch reacts; (5) opener carries on. Once per model per door.
• **One action:** Shoot the trigger at −1; Move up to half to cover or out of sight; or Find Cover.
• No reactions to reactions. Pinned: Find Cover only. 2+ Suppression removes Overwatch. Cumbersome can't react.

Shooting

• Throw 2d6 hit dice **with** the damage dice. Hit: 2d6 + **Shoot** + modifiers ≥ **8**. Natural 2 misses; double 6 is a critical (+1 row).
• Damage total → wound row, +1 if critical, then step down by Armour − AP. Row ≤ 0: no effect.
• Range: beyond short −1, beyond double −2 (shotgun −2/−3). No maximum range.
• Cover: Light ≥⅓ hidden or a model in the way; Heavy ≥½ hidden behind solid material.

Hit modifier	Value
Aim	+1
Target in Light cover	-1
Target in Heavy cover	-2
Each Suppression on shooter	-1
Shooter has any Wounded markers	-1
Moved earlier this activation (not Handy)	-1
Reaction or Overwatch shot	-1
Unbraced in zero-g (not Void-trained)	-1
Target in darkness beyond 6" (no low-light gear)	-2

Wound table

Row	Total	Result
1	2–3	Shaken: +1 Suppression
2	4–4	Rattled: +2 Suppression
3	5–5	Grazed: +1 Suppression
4	6–7	Wounded: add a Wounded marker. More markers than Wounds: Down
5	8–9	Wounded and +1 Suppression. More markers than Wounds: Down
6	10–11	Down: may recover (end-of-round test 8+, or Medic)
7	12–13	Down and bleeding: dies at end of third round unless Medic 8+
8	14–15	Critical: dies at end of next round unless Medic 10+
9	16–18	Dead
10	19+	Dead; friends within 1" gain 1 Suppression

Rows above 10 count as 10. Wounded = −1 to all rolls.

Weapon and armour keywords

Keyword	Effect
Handy	Ignores the moved-this-activation penalty.
Auto	Auto N: may use Suppressive Fire. Shoot or Suppressive Fire may engage up to N models within 3" of the first target, one roll each, -1 after the first.
Suppressing	A hit also adds 1 Suppression.
One per round	May fire once per round, including reactions.
Cumbersome	An extra -1 when firing after a Move; cannot fire as a reaction.
Blast	Affects every model within the blast radius with line of sight to the point of impact.
Confined	+1 wound row to models in an enclosed compartment of 6" x 6" or smaller.
Breach	Can destroy doors, hatches and thin bulkheads.
Silenced	Shots do not count as noise for the alert track.
Sealed	Protected from vacuum and smoke; resists decompression tests (+2).
Heavy	Bulky armour. Its weight is already reflected in the wearer's Move.
Suppressive Fire (action)	Auto weapons only. Hit roll, no damage: +1 Suppression, or +2 if the roll beats 8 by 3+.

Imperator Black — Quick Reference (2)

Weapons

Weapon	Dmg	Short	AP	Keywords
Sidearm	2d6	8"	0	Handy
SMG	2d8	12"	0	Handy, Auto 2
Carbine	2d8	18"	0	Handy
Shotgun	2d12	10"	0	Handy
Rifle	2d8	30"	0	—
Heavy rifle	2d8	30"	1	—
LMG	2d8	30"	0	Auto 3, Suppressing
Compact LMG	2d8	18"	0	Handy, Auto 3, Suppressing
DMR	2d10	48"	0	—
AT launcher	2d12	36"	1	One per round, Cumbersome

Melee	Dmg	AP
Unarmed / weapon butt	2d4	0
Knife or bayonet	2d8	0
Breaching tool or heavy blade	2d10	0

Armour	Value	Keywords
None	0	—
Flak	1	—
Void suit	1	Sealed
Composite plate	2	—
Void plate	2	Sealed
Heavy plate	3	Sealed, Heavy

Close combat

• Starts when a model Moves into contact (a Move: it can trigger reactions). Resolves at once, in exchanges.
• Each exchange: both roll 2d6 + **Fight**. Charge +1 (first exchange); +1 per friend also touching the enemy (max +2); −1 per Suppression; −1 if Wounded.
• Higher wins and rolls its melee damage on the wound table. Tie: both +1 Suppression. No effect: loser still +1 Suppression.
• A model at 5 Suppression that loses is overpowered: Down, or captured if allowed.
• After each exchange the loser, then the winner, declares Continue or Break. It ends only when both break (each moves 1" apart).

Grenades and breaching

• Throw up to double range: test 2d6 + **Physique** (−1 beyond range), 8+ lands on target. Miss: lands short by the miss (min 1"). Natural 2: lands 2" in front of the thrower. Zero-g: bounces past instead.
• Frag: one damage roll for all; step down per model's Armour; Heavy cover −1 row; same compartment ≤ 6"×6": +1 row.
• Breaching charge: place (Interact), detonate later (action). Door destroyed; within 1": 2d6; far side within 2": +2 Suppression, no reactions this round.
• **Crack and throw:** within 1" of a closed, unlocked door: open it and Throw in one Interact, before anyone reacts. Miss: lands in the doorway.
• Locked door: charge; breaching tool (Interact, test 8+); or hack (Interact, 2d6 + Tech, quiet): Basic 7+; Secured 9+; Hardened 9+ ×2; Military 10+ ×2. +1 per earlier failed attempt on it (max +3).

Grenade	Range	Radius	Effect
Frag grenade	8"	2"	2d8 damage
Flashbang	8"	3"	+2 Suppression; removes Overwatch; cannot react until end of round
Smoke grenade	8"	2"	Blocks line of sight through the area until end of next round

Suppression, morale, casualties

• Suppression: −1 to all rolls each (max 5). **Pinned at 3+**: only Rally, Find Cover, Move to cover/out of sight, Shoot from cover.
• Casualty shock: friend within 6" goes Down or Dead: +1 Suppression (+2 if the Leader).
• Breaking: half a fireteam out → each tests 2d6 + **Nerve** (+1 Leader within 6") at activation; fail = both actions moving away.
• Wounded markers from rows 4–5; any marker −1 to all rolls; more markers than Wounds → Down. Down: end of round 2d6 + **Physique** 8+ to rise (3 Suppression, markers = Wounds). Medic action, 2d6 + **Tech**: Down 8+ (auto with Medic), Bleeding 8+ (becomes Down), Critical 10+ (stabilised).

Ship hazards

• **Zero-g:** push off in a straight line; end on a surface or keep drifting. Unbraced −1 to shoot, throw and fight (not Void-trained).
• **Decompression:** each model tests 2d6 + Physique, 8+ (+2 Sealed), or is dragged d6" to the breach; doors seal at end of round; vacuum follows.
• **Vacuum:** unsealed models ending an activation there go Critical. Shooting is silent. No fire or smoke.
• **Fire:** 2d6 damage on entering or ending there (Sealed +1 armour); spreads on 10+, out on 2–3; extinguish 2d6 + Tech, 8+.
• **Darkness:** seen only within 12"; −2 beyond 6" unless Low-light; a model that shot this round is seen at −1.